

Christopher Soria CV

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Education

Year	Degree	Institution
2027	Ph.D. Demography	University of California, Berkeley
2022	M.A. Demography	University of California, Berkeley
2018	B.A. Sociology	University of California, Berkeley
2016	T.C. Sociology	City College of San Francisco

Dissertation

“Examining the Relevance of Social Network Characteristics and Cognitive Aging: A Causal Inference Study” (Expected 2027)

Committee: William H. Dow (Chair), Claude Fischer, Dennis Feehan

Research Interests

Health disparities and mortality; aging and dementia; partisan polarization and health behaviors; social networks; computational social science and applications of Large Language Models in demographic research.

Publications

Peer-Reviewed

Llibre-Guerra, J. J., Wu, Y.-T., Acosta, I., **Soria, C.**, Sosa, A. L., Acosta, D., Jiménez-Velázquez, I. Z., Guerra, M., Salas, A., Lu, R., Llibre-Rodriguez, J. J., & Prina, M. (2026). Trends in Dementia Prevalence Across Latin America and the Caribbean. *JAMA Neurology*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1001/jama.neurol.2026.2305>

Fischer, C. S., & **Soria, C.** (2026). Why Would Others Help Me?: How People Explain Why They Can (or Cannot) Rely on Family and Friends. *Social Psychology Quarterly*.

Llibre-Rodriguez, J. J., Zayas, T., Llibre-Guerra, J. J., Diaz, N., Martinez, Z., Santos, A., Liu, M.-M., **Soria, C.**, Acosta, D., Jiménez-Velázquez, I. Z., & Dow, W. H. (2026). Prevalence of Dementia and Modifiable Risk Factors among Older Adults in Cuba: A Population-Based Study. *Neuroepidemiology*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1159/000553277>

Soria, C. (2026). CatLLM: A Python package for Generating, Assigning, and Scoring Open-Ended Survey Data and Images. *Journal of Open Source Software*. <https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.09678>

Liu, M.-M., Llibre-Guerra, J., **Soria, C.**, Li, J., Zayas Llerena, T., Rodriguez, G., Acosta, D., Jiménez-Velázquez, I., Llibre-Rodriguez, J. J., & Dow, W. H. (2025). The Caribbean American Dementia and Aging Study: Protocol for a population-based study of older adult health and dementia in Cuba, the Dominican Republic, and Puerto Rico. *BMC Geriatrics*, 25, Article 669. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12877-025-06131-0>

Llibre-Guerra, J. J., Weiss, J., Li, J., **Soria, C.**, Rodriguez-Salgado, A., Llibre-Rodriguez, J. J., Jiménez-Velázquez, I. Z., Acosta, D., Liu, M.-M., & Dow, W. H. (2024). Assessing the 10/66 Dementia Classification Algorithm for International Comparative Analyses with the US. *American Journal of Epidemiology*. Published online December 26, 2024.

Soria, C., & Lawton, L. (2023). Connecting Fathers: Fathers’ Impact on Adult Children’s Social Networks. *The International Journal of Aging and Human Development*, 96(1), 19–32.

Zanwar, P. P., Wallace, K. L., **Soria, C.**, & Perianayagam, A. (2022). Commentary: Examining contextual factors contributing to differentials in COVID-19 mortality in US vs. India. *Frontiers in Public Health*, 10, 995751.

Under Review

Soria, C. (2026). Scaling Open-Ended Survey Coding: An LLM Pipeline Where Definitions Do the Heavy Lifting. Manuscript under review at the *Journal of Computational Social Science*. https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/gjvcf_v1

Soria, C. (2026). Model Diversity Over Model Size: Unanimous LLM Ensembles Correct Over-Classification in Survey Coding. Revise and resubmit at *Public Opinion Quarterly*. https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/er6mz_v1

Soria, C. (2026). High Agreement, Different Stories: How LLM Classifiers Reshape Demographic Patterns in Survey Data. Revise and resubmit at *Journal of Survey Statistics and Methodology*. https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/85kyd_v1

Soria, C. (2026). Saturation Prompting: Recovering Stable Categories from Open-Ended Survey Responses with Repeated LLM Extraction. Revise and resubmit at *Survey Practice*.

Soria, C., & Feehan, D. M. (2025). Social Network Structure Rivals Smoking and Income as a Predictor of U.S. County Mortality. Revise and resubmit at *Demography*. https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/kvmx6_v3

Fernández, R. S., Presa, J., Acosta, I., Rodríguez Salgado, A., Sosa, A. L., Acosta, D., Jiménez-Velázquez, I. Z., Longoria Ibarrola, M., Guerra, M., Salas, A., **Soria, C.**, Dow, W. H., Prina, M., Llibre-Rodriguez, J. J., & Llibre-Guerra, J. J.; for the 10/66 Dementia Research Group. (2026). Development and Validation of a Harmonized Diagnostic Algorithm for Dementia and MCI in the 10/66 Population-Based Study. Manuscript under review at *Nature Aging*.

Pre-Prints

Soria, C., Dorelien, A., Feehan, D., & Mahmud, A. (2026). Partisan differences in health behaviors can impact respiratory disease dynamics. medRxiv. <https://www.medrxiv.org/content/10.64898/2026.01.14.26344076v1>

Soria, C. (2026). What Does Frontier Access Buy? Benchmarking LLM Access Tiers and the Reproducibility Case for Open Weights in Survey Coding. SocArXiv. https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/5g34x_v1

Working Papers

Soria, C., Llibre-Guerra, J., Liu, M.-M., Acosta, D., Jiménez-Velázquez, I., Llibre-Rodriguez, J. J., Lee, J., Dow, H. T., & Dow, W. H. (2026). Cross-Cultural Differences in an Online Consensus for Dementia Classification: How Clinicians from Five Countries Interpret the Same Clinical Evidence.

Soria, C., & Fischer, C. (2026). How Do People Make New Friends? Imagined Strategies and Actual Practices.

Stenberg, M., **Soria, C.**, Quigley, S., Madsen, C., & Bedolla, L. (2026). Determinants of Elite Graduate Admissions and the Public School Disadvantage.

Dow, W. H., **Soria, C.**, & Dow, H. T. (2025). Caribbean Hispanic Sociodemographic Heterogeneity: Comparing Older Adults by Country and U.S. Migration Status.

Presentations

Invited Talks

Soria, C. "Survey Data Collection in Social Science."
Sage Research Methods Video: *Doing Survey Research*, Sage Publishing, 2026. [Video](#)

Soria, C. "Scaling Open-Ended Survey Coding: Definitions, Ensembles, and the Limits of Prompt Engineering."

Program on Global Aging, Health, and Policy, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA, June 8, 2026.

Soria, C. "Applying for an F31 Grant: Benefits and Challenges of NIH Funding for Early-Career Researchers."

Invited session, "Understanding NIH-Funded Training Opportunities for Early-Career Population Scientists," Population Association of America Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO, May 7, 2026.

Soria, C. "CatLLM: Augmenting Social Science Research with Large Language Models."

University of Washington, Seattle, WA, October 29, 2025.

Dow, W. H., & **Soria, C.** "Hispanic Migrant Cognitive Aging."

University of Texas Rio Grande Valley, July 1, 2025.

Soria, C. "Partisan Differences in the Spread of Disease."

Wonderfest Science Envoy Event, HopMonk Tavern, Novato, CA, March 18, 2025. [Recording](#)

Soria, C. "Partisan-Influenced Health Outcomes."

KPOO Radio, San Francisco, CA, February 3, 2025.

Soria, C. "Measuring and Modeling the Impact of Partisan Differences in Health Behaviors on Respiratory Infectious Disease Dynamics."

Center for Studies in Demography and Ecology (CSDE), University of Washington, November 1, 2024.

Guilbeault, D., & **Soria, C.** "Researching with LLMs: Integrating Large Language Models into the Research Toolkit."

D-Lab Workshop, University of California, Berkeley, May 6, 2024.

Conference Presentations

Soria, C. "Using LLM Ensembles to Improve Classification of Open-Ended Survey Responses."

Pacific Chapter of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR), hosted by KFF, August 21, 2026.

Soria, C. "Advances in Modeling Human Behavior and Infectious Disease Spread."

Minisymposium, European Conference on Mathematical and Theoretical Biology (ECMTB), Graz, Austria, July 13, 2026.

Soria, C. "A Multinational Framework for Online Cognitive Impairment Diagnosis in the Caribbean American Dementia and Aging Study."

Gateway/HCAP consensus session, Alzheimer's Association International Conference (AAIC), London, UK, July 12, 2026.

Soria, C. "Social Isolation, Loneliness, and Post-COVID Cognitive Decline in Older Adults."

International Network for Social Network Analysis (INSNA) Sunbelt Conference, Daytona Beach, FL, June 27, 2026.

Soria, C. "An Empirical Investigation into the Utility of Large Language Models in Open-Ended Survey Data Categorization."

American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR) Annual Conference, Los Angeles, CA, May 13, 2026.

Soria, C., & Feehan, D. "The Role of Social Structure in County-Level Mortality Disparities."

Population Association of America Annual Meeting, St. Louis, MO, May 9, 2026.

Soria, C. "Automating Survey Analysis with Large Language Models: A Hands-On Workshop Using CatLLM."

Session 103, Innovative Data Methods and AI Applications, PAA Applied Demography Conference, Virtual, February 10, 2026.

Soria, C. "Utilizing AI for Demographic Research: Applications of Large Language Models for Data Categorization and Theme Extraction."

Panel presentation, Population Reference Bureau, Population Association of America Annual Meeting, April 12, 2025.

Soria, C., Dow, W., & Dow, H. "Comparing Sociodemographic Characteristics of Older Hispanic Adults in U.S. Immigrant Populations with Those in Countries of Origin."

Population Association of America Annual Meeting, April 12, 2025.

Soria, C., Stenberg, M., Quigley, S., Madsen, C., & Bedolla, L. "Determinants of Elite Graduate Admissions and the Public School Disadvantage."

Pacific Sociological Association Conference, San Francisco, CA, March 27, 2025.

Soria, C., Stenberg, M., Quigley, S., Madsen, C., & Bedolla, L. "Determinants of Elite Graduate Admissions and the Public School Disadvantage."

California Association for Institutional Research (CAIR) Conference, November 22, 2024.

Soria, C., Dorelien, A., Feehan, D., & Mahmud, A. "Political Beliefs, Partisanship, and Health Behaviors During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Unraveling the Influence of Political Environments on Health Behaviors."

Population Association of America Annual Meeting, Columbus, OH, April 2024.

Soria, C. "Evaluating LLM Accuracy for Survey Data Classification."

PAA Applied Demography Conference, Virtual, February 6, 2024.

Soria, C. "Father Connection & Support in Adulthood."

Population Association of America Annual Meeting, Virtual, May 7, 2021.

Soria, C. "Through Father Meets World: How a Close Father Could Affect Adult Social Networks."

CAL-ADAR Symposium, Boston, MA, November 13, 2018.

Soria, C. "The Well and the Lighthouse: How Family Structure Contributes to the Increasing Gender Gap in College Enrollment."

Pacific Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Long Beach, CA, March 30, 2018. Also presented at the UC Berkeley Sociological Symposium, April 22, 2018.

Research Funding

NIH F31, National Institute on Aging (1F31AG087682-01A1), 2025–2027, \$99,652

"Examining the Relevance of Social Network Characteristics and Cognitive Aging: A Causal Inference Study"

Libby Fee Research Fellow, Greater Good Science Center, UC Berkeley, 2024, \$5,000

Mentored Research Award, UC Berkeley Graduate Division, 2024–2025, \$36,000 plus in-state tuition and fees

Honors & Awards

Bashir Ahmed Graduate Fellowship, 2025

Diversity Fellowship, 2022–2023

Data Science for Social Justice Fellow, 2022

Chancellor's Fellowship, 2021–2022

The Danesha McCoy Award for Excellence in Scholarship, 2018

Trainee Fellowship, Cal-ADAR: Advancing Diversity in Demography of Aging Research, 2016–2018

High Distinction, College of Letters & Science, 2018

Highest Honors in Sociology, 2018

Alpha Kappa Delta Honor Society, 2017

Research Experience

Graduate Student Researcher, Caribbean American Dementia and Aging Study, UC Berkeley (2023–Present)

- Designed data collection and processing infrastructure using Python and Stata for a multi-country study across Cuba, the Dominican Republic, and Puerto Rico
- Developed a system of linked digital surveys segmented by unit of analysis (individual, household, neighborhood)
- Applied Large Language Models and Vision Models with human annotators to classify and score images for dementia assessments
- Managed real-time data collection, quality control, and analysis across three countries

Graduate Student Researcher, UC Berkeley Social Networks Study (2022–Present)

- Collaborated with Professor Claude Fischer on social network determinants of internal U.S. mobility using causal inference methods
- Developed best practices for applying Large Language Models to social science research

Graduate Student Researcher, CenSoc, UC Berkeley (May 2022–May 2023)

- Produced a complementary dataset for CenSoc data (N=49 Million) linking Social Security Administration death records to contextual variables
- Utilized the Google API for geocoding and spatial analysis of zip codes
- Analyzed patterns of missingness in mortality records to identify representativeness issues

Research Associate, BluePath Solutions (Nov 2019–Apr 2020)

- Conducted literature reviews and interpreted clinical trial data for pharmaceutical research
- Developed budget impact models for new drug assessments

Research Assistant, UCLA Health Creative Health for Youth in Pain Project (Aug 2019–Feb 2020)

- Synthesized scientific literature on adolescent chronic pain for clinical and general audiences

Research Assistant, UC San Diego (Jan 2019–Aug 2019)

- Extracted and cleaned data from academic journals; contributed to research methodology

Research Assistant, UC Berkeley Social Networks Team (Jul 2017–Aug 2018)

- Applied linear, generalized linear, and ordinal logistic regression models using SPSS
- Conducted factor analyses and merged datasets; performed a literature review on fatherhood research

Scholar, UC Berkeley Department of Demography, Cal-ADAR Program (Jun 2017–Aug 2018)

- Conducted independent research on differential effects of father absence by child gender
- Funded by the National Institute on Aging under the guidance of Dr. Leora Lawton

Lead Research Apprentice, UC Berkeley URAP (Sep 2016–Aug 2018)

- Supervised a 10-person team extracting and digitizing microfilm data
- Led qualitative coding and analysis of historical documents

Fieldwork

Dominican Republic & Puerto Rico (2024) — Caribbean American Dementia and Aging Study

- Coordinated the data collection process and trained interviewers
- Developed strategies for enhancing response rates
- Supervised field interviewers and managed data organization

Service & Outreach

Science Envoy, Wonderfest (2024–2025)

- Selected for a competitive program training Ph.D. students in science communication
- Delivered public talks translating research for general audiences

Blogger, Huffington Post & Medium (2016–2020)

- Published political analysis pieces, some of which received over 20,000 views

Technical Skills

Category	Skills
Programming	R (proficient), Python (moderate), Stata (moderate)
Methods	Regression, factor analysis, causal inference, survey design, content coding, data engineering
AI/ML	Large Language Models for survey analysis and data categorization, AI-assisted data engineering

Languages

English (native), Spanish (fluent)

Open Source Projects

- **CatLLM** — A Python package for categorizing open-ended survey responses using Large Language Models. Peer-reviewed in the *Journal of Open Source Software*; 100,000+ downloads on PyPI; also available for R and Stata. [GitHub](#)

Professional Memberships

- Population Association of America
- Pacific Sociological Association